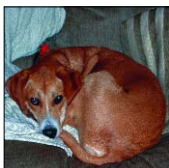


Dog Eats Phone!

A dog in Turkey recently ate its owner's cell phone. The owner discovered it only when he dialled the number and heard something ringing in the dog's stomach. The owner, a petrol station attendant, initially thought the phone had been stolen by a motorist filling fuel.



Humans Often Responsible For Data Loss

Data recovery experts say that human behaviour is to blame in many cases of data loss. One executive recently froze his crashed hard disk thinking it would be fixed. Another man got so angry with his laptop that he tried to flush it down the toilet.



Escape

CRIME DOES PAY

Virus Writer Turns Software Pro

A one-time member of the 29A virus-writing group, Benny, 22, is now working as the main developer of Czech firm Zoner Anti-Virus (ZAV). Benny was involved in the computer virus underground for five years, culminating in his membership of 29A (hexadecimal for "666"). 29A is well known for developing proof-of-concept code, not for mass-mailing viruses.

Zoner hired Benny to develop security software to protect servers run by Zoner's Internet division.

Most anti-virus firms refuse to employ virus writers because it's bad for public relations. In general, the industry wants to distance itself from malware authors, and to discourage the idea that writing viruses is a path into a lucrative career in computer security. There's

also the concern that potential customers could be put off from buying security software written by someone who once used to create malicious code.

Although the rehabilitation of virus writers is to be encouraged, it's questionable whether reformed virus writers even belong in the IT security industry. Anti-virus firms say that the skills needed to develop security software are different from those needed to write malicious code.

NO PC FOR YOU

Schoolboy Sues Mother

A 11-year-old in Xingzheng in China took his mother to court because she refused to buy him a PC.

The schoolboy's mother had promised him a computer if he got more than 94 per cent for his school-work. However, despite the boy scoring 97 per cent, his mother refused to get him the PC he so badly wanted. She cited lack of money as the reason.

The boy then took his mother to court in an effort to make her honour the verbal agreement. The judge reconciled the pair at the hearing.

DATED ONLY FOR THE SEX

Serial Dater Banned

Fifty-five-year-old Clive Worth, of Llanelli, Wales, arranged, over a period of five years, 119 dates through DatingDirect.com,

UNUSABLE!



indiasnews.com

Indiasnews.com is supposed to be a one-stop news site. There is a collection of links to various news items across several major online Indian news sites. Each click even opens up a nice new window with the news item. But the folks at Indiasnews.com don't seem to have got the idea that a news site needs to be updated regularly—preferably, daily. As of the November 25, every single news link pointed to news from November 4! Perhaps they update the site once a month...

Win!

My Desktop

Think you have the most beautiful, most innovative desktop around? Send it to mydesktop@thinkdigit.com, and Digit will publish the most eye-catching of them each month.



The winner will receive a KUSBTD1/128FE USB stick worth Rs 1,300. This month's winner is Abhimanyu Ghoshal.

Sponsored by



ON A WING: A dock, PNG icons, Winamp 5, Talisman 2.8 (and transparencies!) This desktop flutters right onto our hearts. Sent by Abhimanyu Ghoshal

a UK-based Web dating service. Most of the dates ended with sex. The agency received complaints about Worth's "lack of commitment," and he was struck off their list.

Worth told the *Mirror* tabloid: "I'm gutted about being kicked out. I've done nothing wrong. The agency said they received complaints because women were travelling to meet me and wanted commitment, but I didn't. But it's just that I haven't met the right woman yet."

Worth also said he would not take the ban lying down, and vowed to sign up with another agency—and continue his quest for the right woman until he's 80.